Why Sexual Violence Persists

GS I

- Sexist attitudes and **gender stereotypes** can make disrespect towards women seem normal. When jokes about rape, sexualisation of women and disregard for consent become common, people may fail to recognise or challenge behaviour that can lead to sexual violence.

- People who know about sexual abuse may remain silent because of friendship, loyalty, fear or **social pressure**. Such silence protects offenders rather than victims and makes it easier for serious wrongdoing to continue without immediate intervention.

- Rules have little effect when institutions do not enforce them properly. Weak investigations, inadequate punishment or reluctance to confront offenders can create a **sense of impunity**, where people believe they may escape serious consequences for their actions.

- When society remains silent and institutions respond weakly, survivors may suffer greater consequences than offenders. This imbalance can discourage **accountability** and allows the conditions that enable sexual violence to continue even when formal rules exist.

Rules alone cannot prevent sexual violence. They work only when society challenges harmful attitudes, people speak against abuse and institutions hold offenders accountable.